their business or smoking chatting and drinking coffee and at night they meet at each others houses to play at whist and other games at cards, and they play high too, like all the Christians of Constantinople. They dress in an odd fashion which is called European here, they wear great coats of cloth buttoned up to the chin or sometimes fur pelises which look much better, Persian caps and loose Cossack trousers and almost all wear their beards.

[EDWARD BURGESS TO GEORGE BURGESS] *Tabreez, May 7, 1844*

I received your most kind and affectionate letter on the 27th ulto It is dated New York 26th Feby therefore it has come very quickly. In answer to your questions, I am sorry to say that I cannot accept your kind offer, because I cannot leave Persia without coming to some arrangement with my creditors, that is without running away, which you know I would never do. I believe that now my destiny is fixed for Persia, that is I do not at all dispair of being able to get to England for a time if I could come to some arrangement with my creditors, but from my knowledge of the Persian and Turkish languages and my knowledge of Asiatic affairs it is most likely that my occupations whatever they may be, will be in some way or other connected with the East. My salary with Mr Bonham was Ts 400. a year, about £180. But he has left off trading and my agreement with him was up on the 21st March, last. And I am now no longer in his service. I mentioned this to the Prince governor, and he has agreed to give me the same pay, so I am now in his service. My work is translating the newspapers, and other things. But the Prince has ordered me not to mention that I am in his service, as the Prime minister, who is his enemy, might make it a pretence for troubling him. Therefore please do not mention this in any way so that it might come back to Persia. The answer I shall give to any one who asks me is that the Prince gives me something for my translations. And this year I hope to make something out of the two villages of which I am governor. If the Prince Bahman Meerza was not afraid of the Prime minister, he would I am pretty sure put me into some place which would give me an opportunity of earning something towards paying my debts, indeed he has promised to advance me as soon as ever an occasion occurs, but he is obliged to be cautious as a word from the minister would force him to deprive me of my place. There are several villages in the district of Ouroumia[70] inhabited by Nestorian Christians; these people are much oppressed by their chiefs, and they, seeing that I governed the two villages which are under my charge (the inhabitants of which are all Mahomedans) with justice, and much to the advantage of the villagers, sent some

[70] Cf. Justin Perkins, passim, op. cit.

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